EXP 8
Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

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1. AIM

Toconfigure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) for the "Job Application Form" application in Zoho Creator, so that every category of user — Super Admin, Manager, employee, and portal-based customers — is assigned an appropriately scoped role and permission profile, record visibility follows the reporting hierarchy and the data sharing rules, and the application interface is localized correctly for each user, without granting any user access beyond what their role requires.

2. PROCEDURE

2.1 Defining Roles and the Role Hierarchy

1. Open the application in Zoho Creator and go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Roles tab. Select the "Manager" role, set "Reports to" as CEO, and add the description "reporting information".
2. Set "Share Data with Peers" to Yes so that users placed under the same role can view each other's job application records. The users assigned to this role are listed under Associated Users.

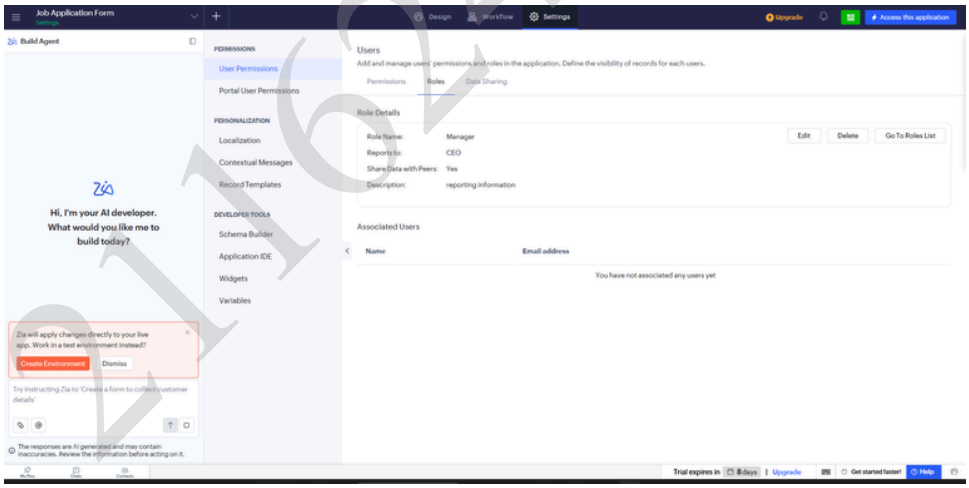


Fig 2.1: Roles tab — Manager role configured with reporting hierarchy

Explanation: The "Reports to" field builds the reporting chain (Manager to CEO) that Zoho Creator uses to decide which records a role can see above its own. "Share Data with Peers" extends visibility sideways to others holding the same role, so managers can see and review the same job applications. Together these settings define the vertical and horizontal reach of the Manager role's access, and the Associated Users table shows exactly who holds the role (at this stage no users have been associated with it yet).

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2.2 Creating Permission Profiles for Each User Category

3. Go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Permissions tab and click "Add Permission" to create a separate permission profile for each category of user, each with its own descriptive name, alongside the built-in Write profile. In this application the "manager" profile (description: "supervising the event") and the "sadhana" profile (read permission for all components) were created.

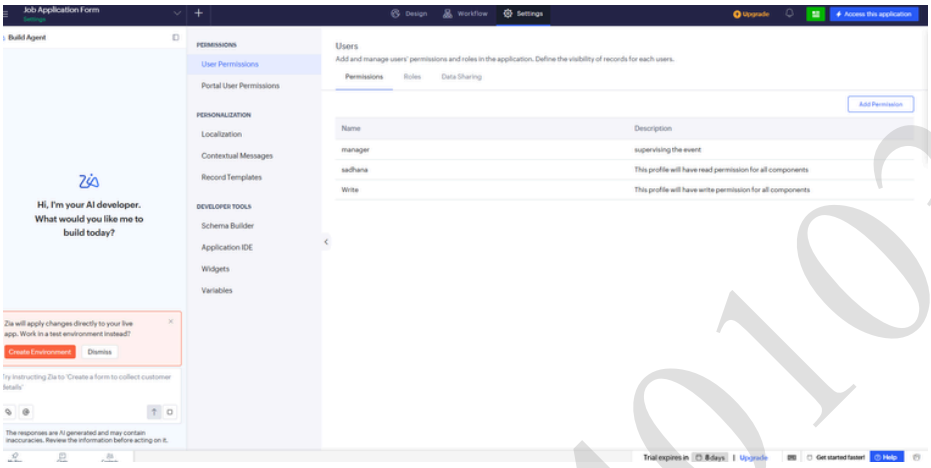


Fig 2.2: Permissions tab listing the permission profiles available in the application

Explanation: Each permission profile is an independently editable set of module-level and field-level access rights. The "manager" profile is meant for the person supervising the application process, the"sadhana" profile gives read permission for all components, and the Write profile gives write permission for all components. Using named profiles instead of one shared profile ensures each user can act only on the forms and reports relevant to their function, which is the core of role-based access control.

2.3 Defining Data Sharing Rules

4. Open the Data Sharing tab and click "New Share Rule". Choose the form (Job Application), the role or user the records are shared from, the role or user they are shared to, and the level of access. Two rules were created: "sadhana" (Manager to Manager, Read/Write) and "Akash" (employee role to user KAMALESH, Read Only).

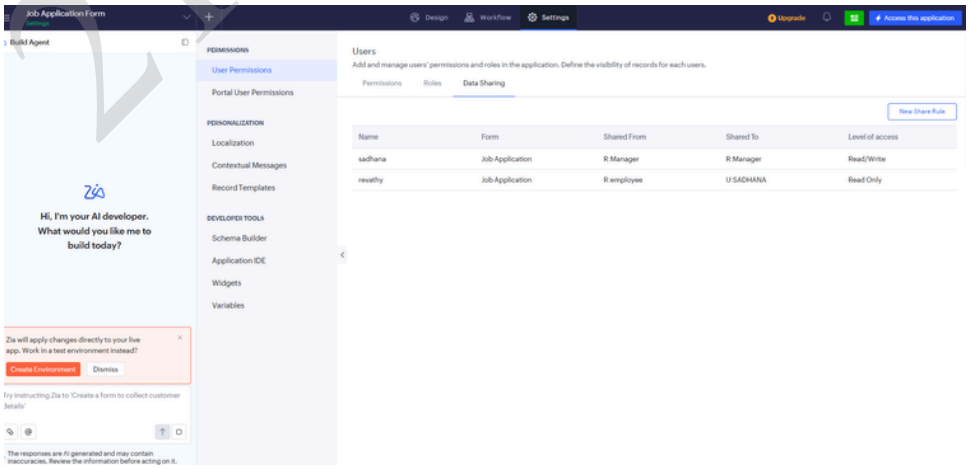


Fig 2.3: Data Sharing tab showing the share rules for the Job Application form

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Explanation: Data sharing rules open up record visibility beyond what the role hierarchy gives by default. In the table, the prefix R: denotes a role and U: denotes an individual user. The first rule lets users in the Manager role view and edit each other's job applications, while the second lets the user KAMALESH see records submitted by the employee role but only with Read Only access, so applications can be reviewed without being altered.

2.4 Setting Portal User Permissions

5. Go to the "Portal User Permissions" tab to manage access for portal users — applicants who interact with the application from outside the core organisation. Here the "Customer" profile is available as a portal-level permission.

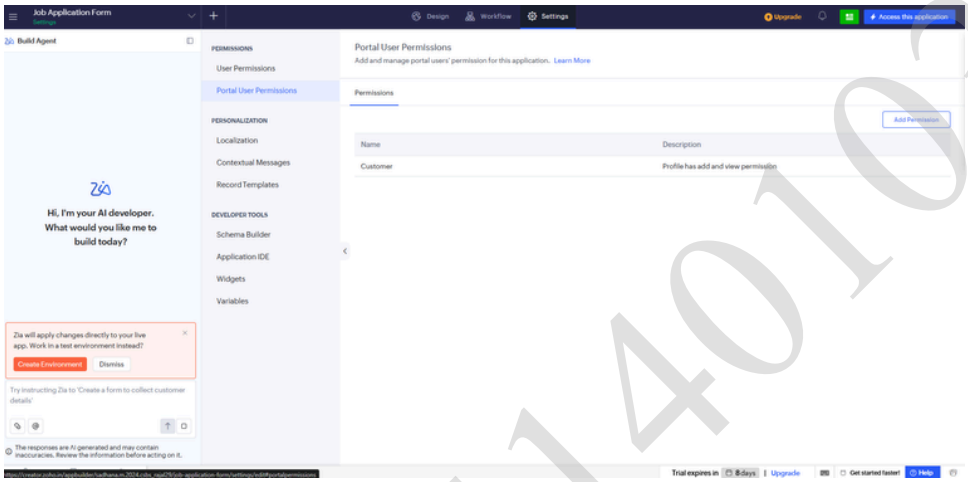


Fig 2.4: Portal User Permissions tab showing the profile available to portal users

Explanation: Portal users are kept separate from internal application users so that applicant-facing accounts can be given a restricted set of permissions without exposing internal roles or developer settings. The "Customer" profile has add and view permission only, which lets an applicant submit a job application and view it, but not change or delete other records.

2.5 Configuring Application Localization

6. Go to Settings > Personalization > Localization and choose which language the application should use. "User's browser language" is selected, with English kept as the default language.

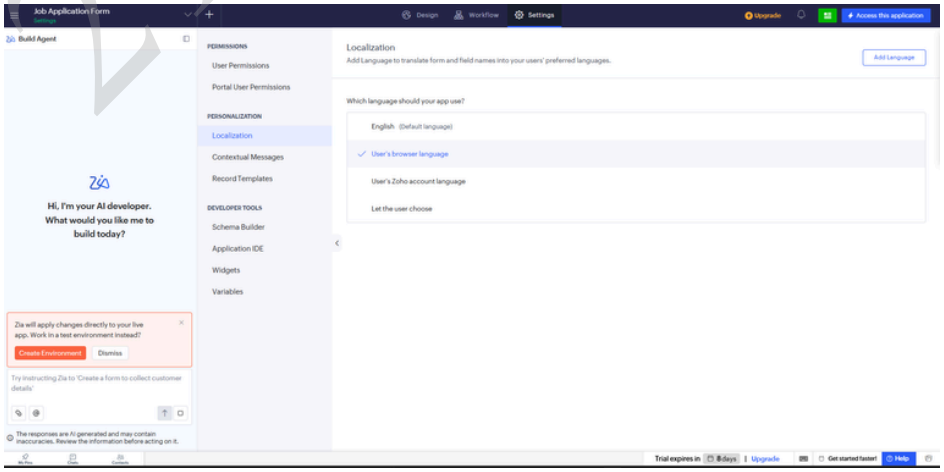


Fig 2.5: Localization settings for the application

Explanation: Localization works alongside RBAC to make the application usable for every user. Once a user's permission profile decides what they can access, the localization setting decides the language in which form and field names are displayed — based on their browser, their Zoho account language, or a language they choose themselves. More languages can be added with the Add Language button.

3. OUTPUT

Once the roles, permission profiles, data sharing rules, portal permissions and localization settings were saved, the All Users page listed the users who have access to the application.

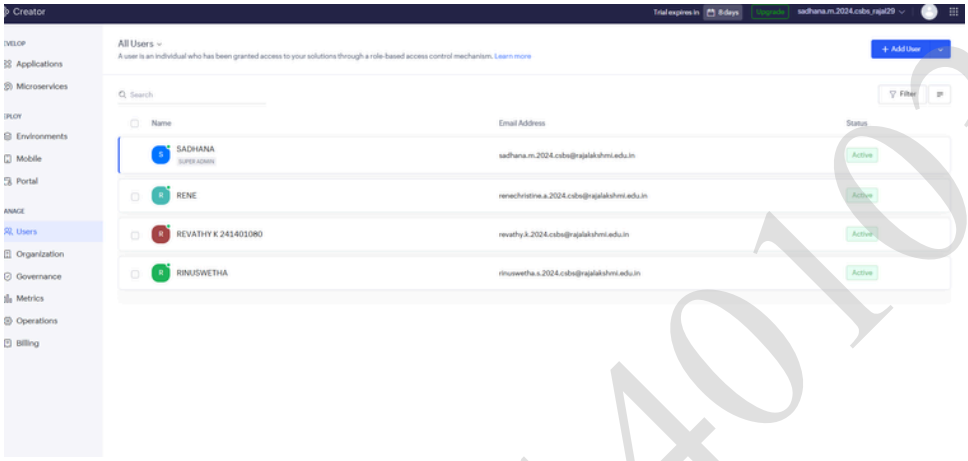


Fig 3: All Users page in Zoho Creator showing the users who have access

Active. This shows the users are set up in Zoho Creator and can sign in and work in the application within the access granted to their role and permission profile.

4. RESULT

Role-based access control was successfully configured for the "Job Application Form" application in Zoho Creator. Distinct roles and permission profiles were created for each category of user, a reporting hierarchy was established for the Manager role with peer data sharing, data sharing rules controlled record visibility between roles and users, portal users were restricted to an add-and-view profile, and the application interface was localized to the user's browser language. This ensures every user interacts only with the data and features appropriate to their role. The users are listed as Active.

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